

Time-Versioned Central Acts of India

An evidence-led methodology for reconstructing
legislation at a date

What did the Indian Contract Act say
on 5 September 1976?

Legal foundations, source discovery, three collection strategies, temporal
reconstruction and verifiable coverage.

Official sources Gazette and India Code	Traceable changes Text, authority and date	Reviewed history Defined scope and cutoff
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23 September 2026
Prepared for legal and technical evaluation

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Executive Recommendation

Build a source-backed history of each Act, with dated versions of its provisions and an explicit statement of coverage. Use India Code to accelerate discovery and structuring, Gazette publications to establish legislative text and change events, and a reconciled inventory to define which Acts are in scope.

The question is simple: What did the Indian Contract Act, 1872 say on 5 September 1976? Answering it reliably requires more than downloading today's Act and sorting amendment PDFs. It requires identifying the relevant principal enactment, **recovering earlier wording, resolving when each provision commenced, and preserving every source** needed to explain the result. Territory, retrospective changes and transitional provisions can qualify that answer.

Three collection strategies are viable:

Strategy	Main advantage	Main limitation
1. India Code led	Fastest route to structured sections, footnotes and linked instruments.	Inherits gaps in discovery and consolidation unless independently checked.
2. Act-by-Act Gazette discovery	Produces useful, individually reviewed Act histories incrementally.	Title searches miss omnibus amendments, some notifications and poorly indexed scans.
3. Gazette enumeration and local indexing	Broadest, most auditable coverage of the selected publication tracks.	Requires substantial collection, OCR and classification; enumeration alone does not establish legal completeness.

Recommended delivery model: use **Strategy 1 to seed each dossier, Strategy 2 to deliver reviewed Act histories**, and **Strategy 3 as the shared collection programme** that tests and improves coverage. Release a history only for its **declared date range, territory and evidence cutoff**. Continue widening the archive independently of those releases.

The existing retrieval pilot provides a credible starting point: 57 recorded search experiments, 1,673 enumerated metadata records and 112 distinct downloaded Gazette PDFs. It **has not yet parsed amendment operations** or produced a certified complete historical Act. Those are separate delivery stages. [E1]

Scope of this report. The first delivery covers **Central Acts, their schedules**, and all instruments needed to reconstruct their **wording and commencement**. Rules and regulations are a subsequent versioning track, but their relationship model is designed from the outset. The report includes legal foundations, source workflows, search evidence, reconstruction rules, limitations and acceptance gates.

Evidence dates. Retrieval experiments: 21 September 2026. Supplied India Code gap log and additional verification: 23 September 2026. These are **observation dates, not a representation that every law or source is current** through those dates.

1. Define the Historical Answer

An Act's **text**, its **commencement**, and its **application to a particular situation** are related but different. A historical-text service should state which it returns.

Output	Question answered	Required qualification
Enacted text	What wording was enacted or promulgated?	Some provisions may not yet be in force.
Text operative at a date	Which provision versions had legally commenced by that date?	Include territory, savings and unresolved commencement conditions.
History known at a cutoff	What could be reconstructed using sources available by a specified cutoff?	Distinguish later retrospective legislation and late archive discoveries.
Legal application	Which law governs this dispute or transaction?	Requires facts, transition rules, exceptions and relevant judgments; beyond text reconstruction alone.

For the Contract Act example, the default request should resolve to **Indian Contract Act, 1872, Act 9 of 1872; date 1976-09-05; Central text; English; declared territorial scope**. Do not treat the informal name "Contract Act" as sufficient identity. The current official text records commencement on 1 September 1872, but **a modern consolidation is not itself proof** of the complete 1976 wording. [S6]

A 1950-onward Gazette collection cannot, on its own, reconstruct an 1872 enactment. The **baseline and pre-1950 changes** must come from original Gazette material or a **documented, authoritative historical edition** with its own cutoff and provenance. Article 372 provides a constitutional basis for continuity of existing laws; it does not supply their historical text. [S2]

The result should contain the provision text, effective interval, status, source pages, the changes that produced it, the reconstruction cutoff and any unresolved limitation. Use explicit states such as **not yet enacted, enacted but not commenced, in force, omitted/repealed**, and **unresolved**. **Do not silently return today's text** when historical evidence is missing.

Proposed boundary: Central text, including amendments to that text and necessary territorial qualifications. State amendments to Central Acts and State-made rules require a **separately declared extension**. A national text must not be presented as every State's applicable version.

Practical consequence: "All Central Acts" **must include repealed predecessors** when they are relevant to the requested historical period. A collection of Acts in force today cannot answer every question about the past.

2. Who Makes and Publishes the Law?

Primary legislation establishes the statutory framework. An ordinary Parliamentary Bill becomes an Act through the constitutional legislative process and presidential assent. Articles 107-111 govern the relevant passage and assent framework; financial and other special procedures must not be flattened into a single universal description. **An amending Act is itself primary legislation** whose provisions alter one or more existing enactments. [S2]

Delegated or subordinate legislation is made by an authority using **power conferred by a parent Act**. The authority may be the Central Government, a named ministry, a regulator or another statutory body. Its power, subject matter, procedure and limits must be traced to the enabling provision. A general power to make rules is **not an unrestricted power to rewrite the Act**. [S3, S5]

Institution	Relevant role	Collection implication
Parliament and President	Enactment; assent; constitutionally permitted ordinance making.	Preserve enacted or promulgated instruments and their commencement provisions.
Legislative Department, Ministry of Law and Justice	Drafting of principal legislation, legislative scrutiny and publication/ compilation functions.	Its Act inventories and publications are valuable official reference sources.
Department of Legal Affairs	Legal advice to government and related legal functions.	Distinguish legal advice from legislation and publication.
Administering ministry or department	Implements the Act; may issue delegated legislation and commencement notices.	Search its publications and historical names, but do not confine principal-Act searches to that ministry.
Statutory regulator	Makes regulations or other instruments within statutory power.	Identify its separate publication track and instrument families.
Government publication and printing authorities	Publish the Gazette and provide its digital archive.	Preserve the published instrument; portal metadata is an additional discovery layer.
India Code	Official legislation database with text, metadata and related instruments.	Use as a structured reference and reconciliation source.

The departmental distinctions are supported by the Ministry's official description. They should not be interpreted as a claim that the Legislative Department administers every Central Act. [S4]

Important exception to "only an Amendment Act changes an Act": Parliament can **expressly delegate a limited power to amend schedules**. Companies Act section 467 provides such a power. S.O. 1256(E), dated 18 March 2021, **inserts and substitutes wording in Schedule V**. An Acts-only product must collect this notification because the target is part of the Act itself. [S5, S7]

Ordinances: Article 123 permits presidential promulgation when both Houses are not simultaneously in session and its conditions are satisfied. An ordinance **has the force of an Act but is temporary**. Its cessation, withdrawal, replacement and saving provisions need separate treatment. It **does not simply "become an Act" automatically**. [S2]

3. Read the Gazette Classification

The **Gazette of India** is the official publication carrying government instruments. **eGazette** is its online access and discovery system. A Gazette issue is a publication container and **may contain multiple instruments**, languages or unrelated notices. It is not necessarily one Act, one rule family or one amendment.

The following map follows the Department of Publication's official contents guide. It is a routing guide, **not a substitute for reading the instrument**. The guide bears an older ministry name; retain its provenance rather than treating that heading as a current organisational chart. [S1]

Gazette location	Contents, in plain language	Relevance
Part I, Sections 1-2	Non-statutory government material and personnel notifications, excluding the Defence categories below.	Usually contextual; follow relevant references.
Part I, Sections 3-4	Defence non-statutory resolutions/orders and personnel material.	Usually contextual.
Part II, Section 1	Acts, Ordinances and Regulations.	Principal and amending enactments; not exclusively Parliamentary Acts.
Part II, Section 1A (Hindi)	Authoritative Hindi texts of Acts, Ordinances and Regulations.	Language counterpart track; not the Bills section.
Part II, Section 2	Bills and select committee reports on Bills.	Legislative history; proposals are not enacted amendments.
Part II, Section 3(i)	General Statutory Rules and instruments of a general character from covered Central authorities.	Rules, amendments and other statutory instruments.
Part II, Section 3(ii)	Statutory Orders and notifications from covered Central authorities.	Commencement, schedule amendments, exemptions and other effects.
Part II, Section 3(iii)	Specified authoritative Hindi texts of statutory rules/orders.	Not a generic Union Territory notices category.
Part II, Section 4	Defence statutory rules and orders.	Needed for relevant Defence enactments.
Part III, Sections 1-3	Specified courts/offices, Patent Office notices and Chief Commissioner material.	Scope-dependent.
Part III, Section 4	Miscellaneous statutory-body notifications, orders, advertisements and notices.	Important regulator track; not every item is a regulation.
Part IV	Private notices and advertisements.	Generally outside legislative text reconstruction.
Part V	Statistical supplement, including births and deaths.	Generally outside scope.

Extraordinary and Weekly/Ordinary are publication categories, not ranks of legal authority. The extraordinary route is convenient for many statutory instruments; a complete collection plan **must assess the ordinary/weekly archive too**. [S1, E1]

Gazette Section 3(ii) and section 3 of an Act are different addresses. **Store them in different fields**. In addition, **Regulations** in Part II Section 1 can include instruments under constitutional authority, such as Article 240; do **not automatically classify them** as a regulator's subordinate regulations. [S2]

4. Decode Citations and Dates

Term or identifier	Meaning	How to store and use it
G.S.R.	General Statutory Rules series.	Preserve series, number, suffix, date, year and issuing authority.
S.O.	Statutory Order series, not "Secretary Order".	Read the operative text; it may commence, amend, exempt or appoint.
S.R.O.	Statutory Rules and Orders; encountered in older and Defence material.	Retain the printed series and verify the applicable publication track.
(E)	Extraordinary-series suffix in citations such as G.S.R. 250(E).	Retain it; it does not identify the parent Act.
Act 18 of 2013	The numbered enactment in its year and jurisdiction.	Keep instrument type and jurisdiction with number/year.
Gazette issue number	Number of a Gazette issue within its publication context.	Not an Act number or notification number.
Gazette ID / UGID	Portal/publication identifier, e.g. CG-DL-E-16072020-220546.	Useful for retrieval; verify the resolved PDF.
F. No.	Issuing department's administrative file reference.	Discovery clue; not normally a globally unique legal identifier.
PDF filename / content ID	Storage or portal identifier.	Do not derive the legal identity or a download URL from it.
Ins.; Subs.; Omitted; w.e.f.	Inserted; substituted; omitted; with effect from.	Editorial footnotes point to evidence; they are not the amending instrument.
ibid.	Reference to the previously cited source in context.	Resolve within the footnote sequence; do not assume a global antecedent.

The classification guide explains the G.S.R. and S.O. categories; actual citations and identifiers are visible in the source examples. [S1, S8, S9]

Retain dates separately. At minimum distinguish assent/promulgation, the printed instrument date, printed Gazette date, portal Issue Date, portal Publish Date, legal effective date, and retrieval time. A signature's digital timestamp is also **not a substitute for commencement**.

One event can have **several effective dates**, each applying to a different provision or territory. Conversely, several instruments can affect the same provision on one day. **Publication order is not a reliable legal tie-breaker.**

The **legal effective date** determines the applicable provision version, subject to retrospective and transition rules. **Retrieval time** records when the database learned about the source. Keeping both prevents a late download from appearing to be a new legal amendment.

A notification number is **reused across years** and may collide across series. Searching for "2351" can be helpful, but accepting a match requires **S.O., year, ministry, date and the actual PDF to agree**. [E1]

5. Establish the Inventory of Acts

Start with the Legislative Department's **alphabetical and chronological lists of Central Acts**. Preserve each downloaded edition, its hash and observation date. **Reconcile the lists** with India Code, official annual enactment lists, repeal lists and the Gazette. These sources define and test the inventory; **no one present-day list proves the universe** of all historical enactments. [S10-S12]

The editions downloaded for this report terminate at serial **891** in the alphabetical list and **859** in the chronological list. The supplied India Code screenshot displays **847** Acts. These are **different observed inventories, not three interchangeable counts** of an agreed legal universe. No reconciliation of the 32-entry list difference has been completed here. Do not choose one count as a completeness target without investigating scope and edition differences. [S10, S11, E0]

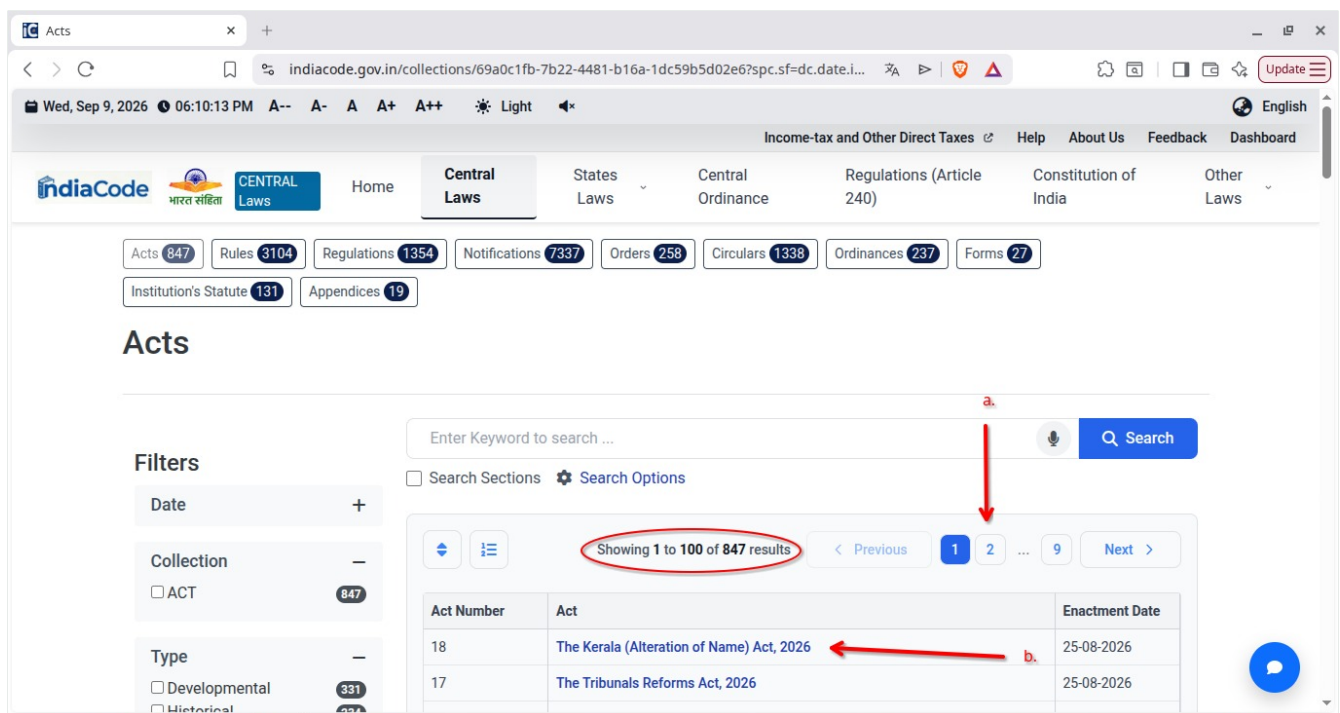


Figure 1. India Code listing, supplied guide p. 4. The annotated count and pagination illustrate how to enumerate the visible collection. The count is a dated observation, not proof of all Acts ever enacted. Original red annotations are retained.

Create an internal register with legal identity, exact title, aliases and former titles, number/year, jurisdiction, instrument kind, enactment date, status and source references. Keep platform UUIDs and handles as **external identifiers**. They help retrieval but should **not be the database's sole definition of an Act**.

Preserve repealed principal Acts and their histories. Also preserve spent or repealed amending Acts: repeal of an amending instrument **does not ordinarily undo textual amendments** already made, subject to contrary intention and applicable law. General Clauses Act section 6A directly addresses this problem. [S3]

Normalisation is for matching, not identity. Generate case-folded, punctuation-tolerant aliases locally; retain the exact printed title. **Never merge Companies Act, 1956 with Companies Act, 2013. Do not infer Act year from short-title year:** the Commercial Courts Act, 2015 is Act 4 of 2016. [S13]

6. Compare the Three Strategies

The strategies differ primarily in **discovery and collection**. **All three still need** identity resolution, **commencement interpretation**, **amendment parsing**, **source-backed review** and version generation.

Dimension	1. India Code led	2. Act-by-Act Gazette	3. Enumerate Gazette tracks
Starting point	Act pages, sections, footnotes and linked instruments.	Reconciled Act register and exact identity.	Publication category, Part/Section and date partitions.
Discovery unit	One Act's visible online dossier.	One Act and its reference network.	Every record in selected archive partitions.
First useful output	Structured current text and candidate timeline.	Reviewed histories for prioritised Acts.	Searchable source archive and coverage ledger.
Initial effort	Lowest, relatively.	Moderate; depends on history and scans.	Highest; downloads, OCR and classification dominate.
Hidden misses	Missing or unlinked records; omitted historical states.	Omnibus titles, delegated changes, poor search metadata.	Archive gaps, wrong categories, failed pages/downloads, unsearchable scans.
Work when stopped	Usable structured text, with disclosed limits.	Completed dossiers plus explicitly partial ones.	Usable completed partitions and supported historical intervals.
Defensible claim	"India Code based" until independently reconciled.	Coverage-reviewed Act/date ranges.	Enumerated available records in specified tracks, not every applicable legal instrument.

Strategy 1 is appropriate for a rapid prototype when users accept documented coverage limitations. It **should not promise authoritative historical completeness** merely because current sections and footnotes are available.

Strategy 2 is appropriate when the delivery unit is a prioritised Act and stakeholders need incremental results. **"500 Acts processed" is not equivalent to "500 complete histories"**. Each Act must pass the same coverage and legal review gates.

Strategy 3 is appropriate for broad discovery and continuing surveillance. Downloading only Part II Section 1 removes one class of title-search misses but **still omits commencement and delegated changes** in other tracks. There is **no verified archive-wide total** of approximately 3,000 relevant documents in this investigation.

A correction to the all-or-nothing assumption: an archive collected only through 2014 is **useful for research** and potentially for reviewed historical intervals. It is not current through 2026. **Later legislation with retrospective effect** can also change today's reconstruction of an earlier date. Every release therefore needs **both a legal date range and a source/knowledge cutoff**.

The recommendation is to **combine the strategies**, while keeping their outputs and claims measurable. There is **no need to finish downloading the entire archive** before producing a carefully bounded, reviewed Act history.

7. Strategy 1: India Code Led

Workflow. Enumerate the Central Acts collection; visit each Act; save metadata, section and schedule text, footnotes, full PDFs, E-Gazette references, the Show Amendment list where present, and related-instrument tabs. Retain raw responses and retrieval timestamps. **Traverse all pages**, including within subordinate collections. [E0, E3]

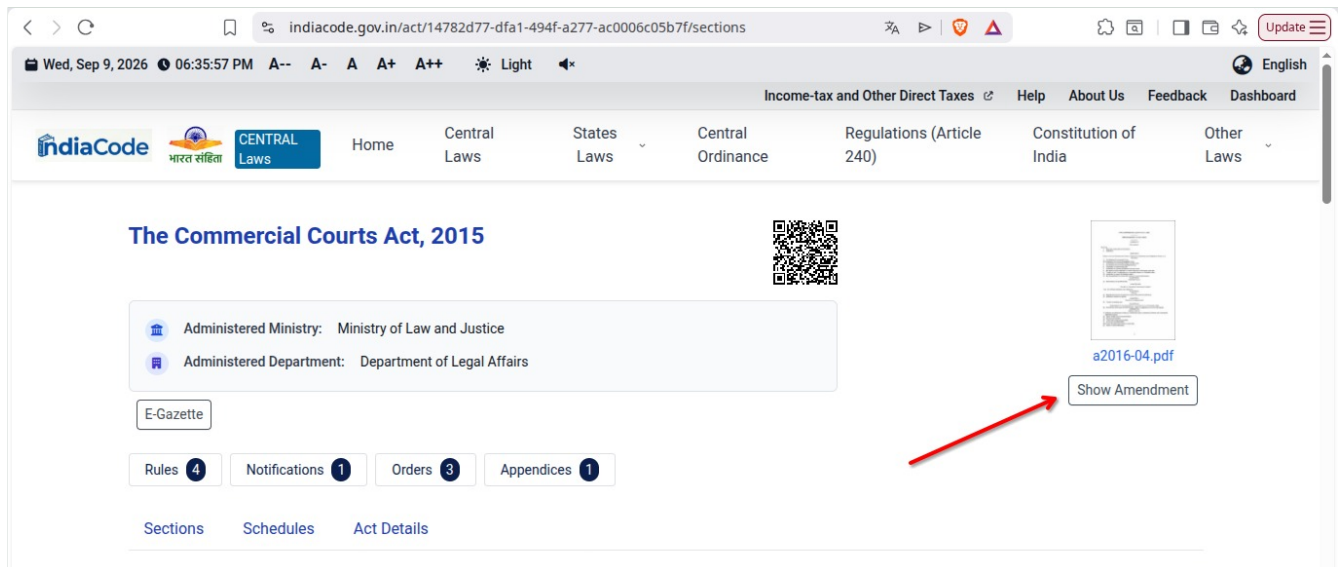


Figure 2. Supplied guide p. 5: the Commercial Courts Act page exposes a PDF, amendment control and subordinate-material counts. The linked full-Act PDF must be inspected; its filename does not establish that it is the original enactment.

Section-level HTML is valuable: it **reduces the work needed to segment a modern consolidation**. It does **not remove the need to parse historical Gazette amendments**, old structures, schedules, omitted units or phrase-level changes. **Keep editorial footnotes separate** from legislative body text.

Resolve every footnote citation, including *ibid.*; fetch the cited amending provision and the authority for its effective date. Use those references to propose a timeline. Obtain a **verified original enactment or a documented historical baseline**. **Do not initialise the replay engine with today's amended PDF** and then apply the same amendments again.

The current Commercial Courts page was checked on 23 September 2026. Its Show Amendment modal links the 2018 amending Act. This confirms that the shortcut works for this example; it **does not establish universal availability or completeness** across Acts.

[E3]

Rules tab complication. A list may intermingle principal rules, successive amendments, forms and instruments from different rule families. A count of "rules" is a **count of records, not necessarily distinct principal rulebooks**. Identify each family using its principal notification, title, enabling provisions and amendment history.

Output and limitation. Deliver a structured dossier and an evidence-backed candidate timeline quickly. **Label missing sources and uncertain dates**. Escalate to Gazette collection and independent ministry/regulator indexes **before describing historical ranges as coverage-reviewed**.

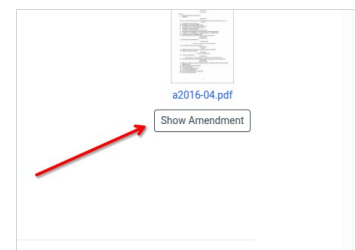


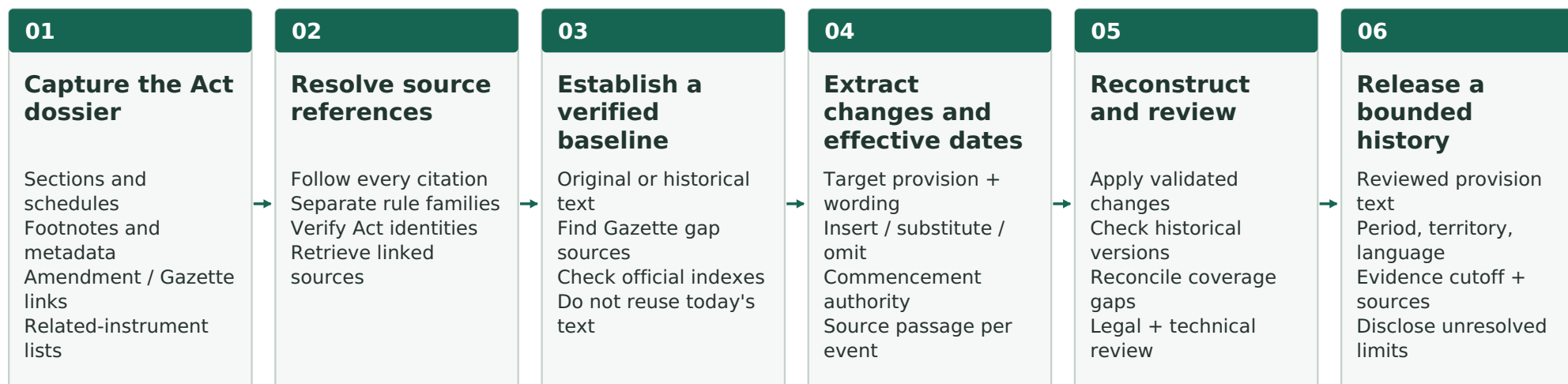
Figure 2, detail. Supplied guide p. 5: the amendment-list shortcut.

Workflow 1. India Code Led

STRATEGY 01 / INDIA CODE LED

Start with structured official text; establish the evidence behind every historical change.

COLLECTION UNIT: ONE ACT'S INDIA CODE DOSSIER



Unresolved source, date or wording: return to reference resolution and Gazette research.

EARLY OUTPUT

Structured dossier and candidate timeline

Useful before historical coverage is verified.

MAIN COVERAGE RISK

Missing or unlinked India Code records

Independent checks are required before release.

Publication is conditional on review. An India Code dossier is a starting point, not proof of a complete history.

Solid arrows: processing sequence. Dashed arrow: further investigation. Release follows successful review of the declared scope; unresolved intervals remain unverified.

8. Strategy 2: Act-by-Act Gazette Discovery

Use the **Legislative Department's alphabetical and chronological lists, reconciled with India Code and enactment/repeal records** (section 5). [S10-S12] For each Act, search **Extraordinary, Part II Section 1, all ministries** using title fragments and broader names. Locate originals and changes; expand dates and ordinary/weekly searches as needed. [E1]

The screenshot shows the eGazette Search interface. The search category is set to 'Extra Ordinary'. The subject field is filled with 'The Companies (Amendment) Act'. The date range is from '28-Jan-1922' to '16-Sep-2026'. The search results table shows 5 gazettes related to the Companies Act, 2020, 2019, 2017, 2015, and 2006.

S. No.	Ministry / Organization	Department	Office	Subject	Category	Part & Section	Issue Date	Publish Date	Gazette ID	Download
1.	Ministry of Law and Justice	Legislative Department	Not Applicable	The Companies (Amendment) Act, 2020.	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 1	28-Sep-2020	28-Sep-2020	CG-DL-E-2809/2020-22070	0.38 MB
2.	Ministry of Law and Justice	Legislative Department	Not Applicable	The Companies (Amendment) Act, 2019.	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 1	31-Jul-2019	31-Jul-2019	NOT available (209478)	1.1 MB
3.	Ministry of Law and Justice	Legislative Department	Not Applicable	This Act may be called the Companies (Amendment) Act, 2017.	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 1	03-Jan-2018	03-Jan-2018	NOT available (181439)	1.49 MB
4.	Ministry of Law and Justice	Legislative Department	NOT available	The Companies (Amendment) Act, 2015.	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 1	26-May-2015	27-May-2015	NOT available (164058)	0.11 MB
5.	Ministry of Law and Justice	Legislative Department	NOT available	The Companies (Amendment) Act, 2006.	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 1	30-May-2006	19-Apr-2011	NOT available (14820)	0.06 MB

Figure 3. Screenshot embedded on supplied guide p. 7: a Companies (Amendment) Act subject search. It illustrates a useful named-amendment query, not a complete Companies Act history. The screenshot uses a wider date range than the 2013-onward pilot, so its count is not directly comparable. The original guide's two Companies-search captions were interchanged; this caption follows the visible query.

Do not strip punctuation and submit only one normalised title. In the recorded pilot, Subject "Companies Act, 2013" returned one result; "Companies Act 2013" returned zero. **Use a query ladder:** exact fragments, distinctive short names, name variants, numeric reference, known dates, body search and reference chasing. **Local normalisation and portal query semantics are separate concerns.** [E1]

For every candidate, download the actual source, **inspect its printed identity**, and **classify the relationship**: original, amends, commences, corrects, repeals, supersedes, applies with modifications, or merely mentions. A Companies-title result may concern the 1956 Act rather than the 2013 Act.

Follow footnotes, schedules and history tables, including **omnibus amendments in Finance Acts and Repealing and Amending Acts. IBC section 255 and its Eleventh Schedule directly amend the Companies Act, 2013**, despite the different title. A "Companies (Amendment) Act" **title-only collection misses these changes; India Code's consolidated text records them.** [S5, S14]

Retrieve **commencement notices and delegated changes to the Act's own schedules** through relevant Section 3 tracks and other legally relevant categories. The Act-only scope excludes full rulebook reconstruction at first; it **does not exclude notifications that change or commence the Act itself.**

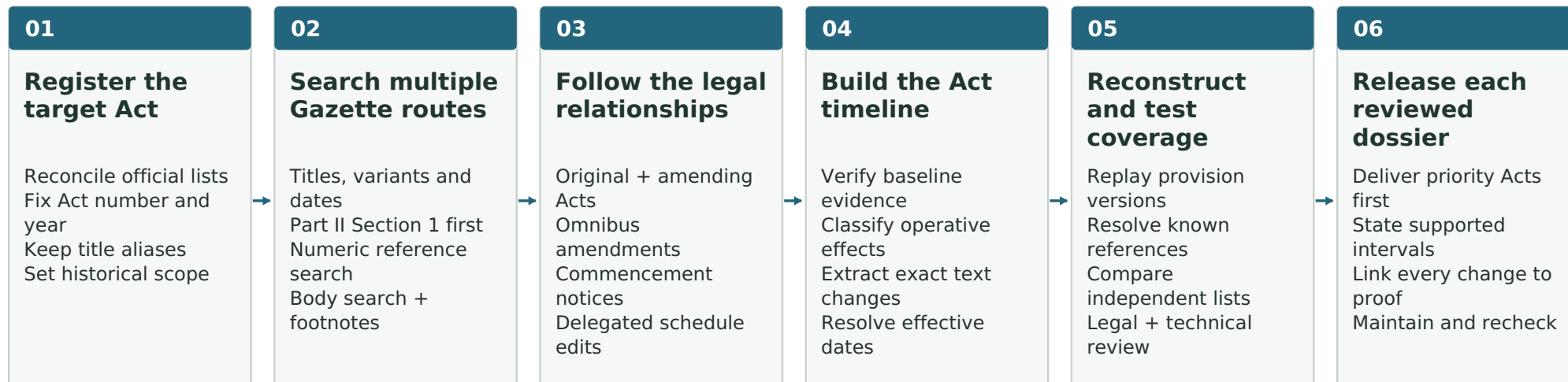
Stopping condition: every known amendment and commencement reference has been **resolved or documented as a blocker**; independent indexes have been compared; the declared coverage partitions and quality checks pass. **An empty further title search is not the stopping condition.**

Workflow 2. Act-by-Act Gazette Discovery

STRATEGY 02 / ACT-BY-ACT GAZETTE DISCOVERY

Deliver priority Acts incrementally through targeted searches and source-reference tracing.

COLLECTION UNIT: ONE ACT AND ITS LEGAL REFERENCE NETWORK



Open references or inconsistent versions: broaden searches and follow additional legal sources.

EARLY OUTPUT

Individually reviewed Act/date ranges

Delivery can proceed before archive-wide collection.

MAIN COVERAGE RISK

Title searches miss differently named instruments

A zero-result search is not a completeness test.

Stop when declared coverage and review checks pass, not when a title search stops finding results.

Solid arrows: processing sequence. Dashed arrow: further investigation. Release follows successful review of the declared scope; unresolved intervals remain unverified.

9. Strategy 3: Enumerate, Then Index Locally

Use the same reconciled Legislative Department alphabetical and chronological lists as the Act inventory. [S10-S12] Enumerate Gazette categories, Parts/Sections and date windows **without Subject or Keyword restrictions**. Save all result pages, metadata and PDFs; extract or OCR the text and **index it locally**. Use the inventory to identify affected Acts from the operative text, **not to limit collection by title**. This reduces dependence on the portal's search indexes. [E1]

Collection track	Initial treatment
Extraordinary Part II Section 1	All ministries; principal and amending legislation, ordinances and other covered instruments.
Relevant Part II Section 3(i) and 3(ii)	Commencement and other statutory effects; expand ministries, historical names and cross-cutting authorities.
Weekly/Ordinary records	Enumerate the relevant tracks; inspect composite issues locally.
Hindi and Defence tracks; Part III statutory bodies	Include according to language, authority and instrument scope.
Poorly classified or uncategorised records	Reconcile through alternate routes and source references; track as a coverage risk.

The prototype enumerated **719** Extraordinary Section 1 records, **584** MCA Section 3(i) records and **370** MCA Section 3(ii) records for 1 January 2013 through 21 September 2026. These **1,673 metadata records are not 1,673 downloaded PDFs**. Only 112 distinct PDFs were collected in that investigation. [E1]

Use annual partitions initially and split dense or unstable periods into months or shorter windows. For each partition retain expected result count, pages traversed, unique record identities, successful downloads, hashes, failures and the last checked timestamp. **A failed or truncated partition remains open.**

The 584-record Section 3(i) broad query was independently compared with year-by-year queries and yielded the same record set without partition duplicates. This **tests traversal consistency** for that track. It **cannot detect an instrument absent from the underlying archive** or misclassified outside both queries. [E1]

Process each completed partition as it arrives. An instrument that amends multiple Acts should enter each affected dossier; **no title match is required if operative text establishes the relationship**. **Headings alone will miss amendments** in schedules and annexures.

Value if collection stops early: a searchable archive, completed publication partitions, and any **Act/date ranges that separately pass review**. Coverage can grow incrementally. **Mark later periods unknown** and do not claim that the latest published law is represented.

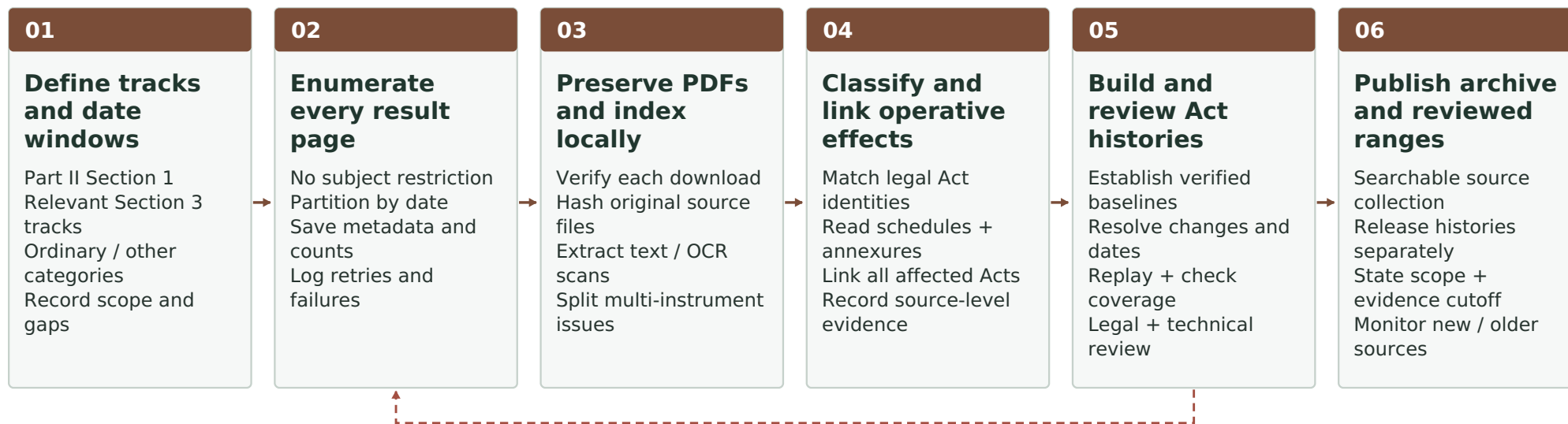
Residual limitation: the available online Gazette is an official evidence source, but a complete crawl of selected online records is **not proof that every historical publication has been digitised or correctly indexed**.

Workflow 3. Gazette Enumeration and Local Indexing

STRATEGY 03 / GAZETTE ENUMERATION AND LOCAL INDEXING

Collect publication tracks broadly, then identify legal relationships from the instrument text.

COLLECTION UNIT: PUBLICATION CATEGORY + DATE WINDOW



Coverage or reconstruction gaps: reopen failed windows and expand source tracks where needed.

EARLY OUTPUT

Completed collection windows and a local index

Process each window as it arrives; no all-or-nothing wait.

MAIN COVERAGE RISK

Archive gaps and omitted publication categories

Complete traversal is not complete legal coverage.

An enumerated archive and a reviewed Act history are separate outputs. Only validated histories support date queries.

Solid arrows: processing sequence. Dashed arrow: further investigation. Release follows successful review of the declared scope; unresolved intervals remain unverified.

10. Recommended Delivery Architecture

Organise work around two linked outputs: a **shared source archive** and **reviewed Act dossiers**. The first maximises discovery; the second is the unit that can be delivered and evaluated.

1. Inventory	2. Sources	3. Relationships	4. Events	5. Versions
Exact Act identity and scope	India Code, Gazette and official indexes	What changes or commences what	Operations and effective dates	Replayed, compared and reviewed

1. **Register the Act.** Fix legal identity, predecessor/successor relationships, date range, territory and language. Record the baseline evidence required.
2. **Seed the dossier.** Capture India Code structure, citations and related instruments. Treat this as a discovery aid and comparison target.
3. **Acquire Gazette candidates.** Combine targeted searches with enumerated publication tracks. Follow every explicit reference and use ministry/regulator indexes to expose gaps.
4. **Preserve and extract.** Keep original bytes, resolve issue-to-instrument boundaries, extract text, OCR scans and retain page-level provenance.
5. **Resolve identities and effects.** Link each operative provision to the target Act, rule family or specific provision. Classify dates independently of textual operations.
6. **Build and review change events.** Require source spans for target, operation, replacement text and commencement. Escalate ambiguous interpretation.
7. **Replay and validate.** Produce versions with stable provision identities; compare to official consolidations and independently reviewed historical examples.
8. **Publish a bounded release.** State the supported period, evidence cutoff, open limitations and reviewer status. Update through new publications and historical backfills.

Keep the evidence layers separate. A source file is an immutable observation. A legal relationship is a sourced interpretation. A change event is a reviewed instruction. A reconstructed version is a reproducible derived output. Correcting one interpretation should **not overwrite the source or erase the audit trail**.

An LLM can propose classifications and structured amendment operations, especially across mixed rule lists and variable drafting styles. Its **output is a candidate until validated**. Source retrieval, exact text spans, target checks and version application **should be deterministic wherever possible**.

Why this combination: it preserves the speed of India's structured official database, the **incremental usefulness of Act-by-Act work**, and the **wider discovery coverage of archive enumeration**. It also avoids making the success of the entire project depend on a single portal search field.

11. Subject and Keyword Search

Search by Gazette Category has separate **Subject** and **Keyword** fields; **Search by TEXT** is another route. **These are not interchangeable.** The observations below date to **21 September 2026**; the portal's **internal search implementation is unverified**. [E1]

Subject: Matching the Stored Description

Results are consistent with **literal, case-insensitive matching against the stored subject description**. This metadata may contain only the opening enabling-power formula, a typo or a misleading title. It is not necessarily the instrument's short title or PDF text: **a term in the PDF need not be searchable through Subject**.

Subject input	Results	What the test establishes
The Companies Act	1	Finds the original, not the amendment family.
The Companies (Amendment) Act	4	Finds named amending Acts, not ordinances or omnibus changes.
Companies	8	Original, four named amending Acts and three ordinances.
companies / COMPANIES	8 / 8	Letter case did not change these results.
Companies Act, 2013 / Companies Act 2013	1 / 0	Removing the comma lost the match.
Companies 2013 / 2013 Companies	0 / 0	Do not assume unordered matching of separate words.
"Companies Act, 2013"	0	Quotation marks did not operate as an exact-phrase instruction.

Failure mode: inserted amendment words can break the original-title phrase; omnibus amendments carry different titles. Local title normalisation helps identity matching, but a single normalised portal query cannot recover the legal family.

Keyword: Undocumented Matching, Not Reliable Body Search

Keyword has **unverified indexed fields and tokenisation**. It is **not established as PDF full-text, exact-phrase or Boolean AND search**.

Keyword input	Results	Interpretation
Companies	7	The original Companies Act was absent.
Companies Act	516	Adding "Act" expanded, rather than narrowed, the result set.
Act	513	Broad matching creates substantial verification work.
Companies Act, 2013	146	A longer title-like input still did not isolate the Act family.
moratorium / workmen	0 / 0	Known IBC body words failed here; Search by TEXT found the IBC.

Test scope: all table rows use Extraordinary, Part II Section 1, all ministries, 1 January 2013 to 21 September 2026. Counts are observations for those filters, **not archive-wide totals**. The patterns do not prove a particular OR operator or backend implementation. [E1]

11A. Full-Text Search and Retrieval Controls

Search by TEXT: Body Discovery With Gaps

The separate **Search by TEXT** route **can find words inside PDFs**, including terms absent from the displayed subject. With Part II Section 1 and publication date **28 May 2016**, "moratorium" and "workmen" each found the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code; a fabricated control term returned no result. "Companies Act" also found that differently titled enactment. This makes body search useful for cross-Act discovery, but **a mention alone does not establish an amendment**. [E1]

The following phrase tests used Extraordinary, Part II Section 3(i), no ministry restriction, **1 January 2014 to 21 September 2026**, on the route's Publish Date field:

Search by TEXT input	Results	Observed behaviour
Companies (Incorporation)	41	Finds body-text candidates.
"Companies (Incorporation)"	41	Quotes did not change the count.
Companies Incorporation	41	Tested punctuation variation was tolerated.
Companies AND Incorporation	0	Do not assume Boolean AND syntax is supported.
Incorporation Companies	0	Reversing the words lost the matches.

These observations suggest **order-sensitive, phrase-like behaviour** for the tested inputs, **not a universal syntax specification**. Do not transfer Subject-field punctuation rules to Search by TEXT, or assume that quotation marks have Google-style semantics.

Known misses: a separate "Incorporation" body search, restricted to MCA, Section 3(i), **2013 to the cutoff, returned 93 records but missed** the original Incorporation Rules, the January 2023 amendment, G.S.R. 349(E)/2015 and G.S.R. 936(E)/2016. Subject searches recovered the first two; a later instrument's history table and reference searches recovered the latter two. The runs prove discovery gaps, but **do not isolate their technical cause** to OCR, indexing or another portal defect. [E1]

References and Dates Can Also Hide Records

For S.O. 2351(E), category search in Section 3(ii), **14-18 July 2020**, returned one result for reference "2351", but none for "2351(E)" or "S.O. 2351(E)". This is **not a universal numeric-only rule**: both "250" and "G.S.R. 250(E)" recovered another instrument with a sufficiently wide date window. **Verify series, year and printed identity** after retrieval.

Category search uses **Date of Issue of Notification**; Search by TEXT uses **Publish Date**. The S.O. 2351(E) record appears under 15 July in the former and 16 July in the latter. A notification-date-only full-text query can therefore exclude the intended record. **Neither field establishes legal commencement**. The Bill/Assent/Act route also reset a requested date window in a recorded test; **inspect the filters actually returned**.

Operational response: combine Subject variants, cautious Keyword candidates, body searches, citation chasing and broader date windows. Keep known-positive controls, record failures, and **enumerate publication tracks without text filters** to test coverage. **A zero result never proves that an instrument does not exist**. Raw runs are preserved in the Act, Keyword, body and text experiment records under evidence/. [E1]

12. Preserve Sources and Retrieve Reliably

The current prototype uses ordinary HTTP requests to the public site's ASP.NET forms. Its successful path **retains session cookies, server form state and dependent dropdown updates**, follows pagination postbacks, then resolves the selected record's PDF viewer. **No documented JSON API for eGazette was identified** in that investigation. [E1]

Capture record and document separately. One record may lead to a composite PDF; the same PDF may be reachable from several records; two different PDFs may reproduce the same legal instrument. **File deduplication, record deduplication and legal-event deduplication** are three different operations.

Preserve	Why it matters
Raw response, query, applied filters and page position	Reconstruct what was searched and whether pages were missed.
Portal title, ministry, Part/Section, issue/publish dates and all IDs	Retain discrepancies instead of silently replacing metadata.
Resolved download URL and retrieval timestamp	Show where and when the bytes came from.
Original PDF, byte count, page count and SHA-256	Detect corruption, replacement and exact duplicate files.
Printed citation, masthead, instrument title and page span	Establish legal identity independently of the portal row.
Extraction/OCR versions and review decisions	Make the derived text and decisions reproducible.

Do not construct download URLs from a visible content number. The original Companies Act resolves to **E_27_2013_425.pdf**, while its legacy displayed number is **155988**. The displayed number was not a valid substitute filename. [S15, E1]

The full-text results page retained a preview of its first result during the earlier tests. Downloading that preview for every selected row would **silently collect the wrong PDF repeatedly**. The prototype instead **resolves the selected row's popup viewer**, then validates distinct source files. [E1]

For production, add **bounded retries, backoff, resumable checkpoints and session recovery**. **Do not mark a partition complete on an HTTP 200 alone**: a server-error page, an empty search response and a successful result page are different outcomes. The existing client retains partial progress but does not yet implement automatic resumption/session repair. [E1]

Use modest request rates and inspect failures before repeating them. **Preserve TLS verification**; the pilot's certificate-chain workaround was specific to the observed issuer and must be revalidated if the site changes.

Integrity boundary: a hash proves that a file is unchanged relative to a recorded copy. It **does not, by itself, establish legal authenticity** or validate a PDF's digital signature. Record signature validation separately when performed.

13. Extract Text Without Losing Evidence

Keep original PDFs immutable. Text extraction, OCR, layout corrections and language segmentation produce derivative files. **Store the tool/model version, settings, source hash and page mapping** for each derivative.

Start with native PDF text extraction. **Assess every page** for missing text, broken character maps, scrambled reading order, mixed scripts, tables and image-only content. A page containing a few correctly extracted header words can still have an unreadable operative paragraph. A simple character-count threshold is **a triage signal, not a quality certificate**.

The pilot contained **3,112 pages**, with **261** flagged for little extracted text. One recovered 2015 notification is a **228-page Hindi scan**. These figures demonstrate real OCR work; they are **not measurements of OCR accuracy** because that work has not yet been completed. [E1]

Document feature	Required handling
Bilingual or multi-column pages	Segment language and reading order; do not interleave parallel legal texts.
Schedules, tables and forms	Preserve rows, columns, notes, cells and images where their arrangement carries meaning.
Old typography and damaged scans	Compare critical spans visually; keep uncertain characters explicit.
Footnotes and headers	Separate editorial material from the provision body; retain references.
Several instruments in one PDF	Identify individual instrument boundaries and page spans.
Corrected or replacement publications	Preserve every file and establish the legal relationship before deduplicating events.

Review the characters that carry legal effect: section references, dates, numbers, negatives, provisos, exceptions and the old/new wording of each edit. **A single missed "not" or misread commencement date** can invalidate a reconstructed version.

LLMs may help interpret layout or propose corrections, but should **never silently repair the legal source**. Keep a **literal transcription layer** and a **separately reviewed normalised layer**. Every proposed replacement text must point to the page region from which it was extracted.

Historical acquisition: if a baseline or amendment is not available online, consult official bound volumes, government libraries, ministry/regulator records and archival holdings. The Central Secretariat Library reports digitisation of Gazette material from 1950 to 2002; that statement is useful context, not a guarantee of every issue's online availability. [S16]

An unavailable source should become an **explicit blocker for the affected date range**. Another well-sourced Act, section or interval **may still be released independently**.

14. Link Instruments to Their Targets

A title is a discovery clue. The **operative provision establishes what an instrument actually does**. Read the definition of "principal Act" or "principal rules", the cited number/year, enabling provision, target address and any schedules containing amendments.

The screenshot shows the 'Search Gazette by Category' interface on the eGazette portal. The search form includes fields for Gazette Category (set to 'Extra Ordinary'), Ministry, Department, Office, Part & Section (set to 'Part II-Section 1'), Issue No., Reference No., Subject (circled in red), Keyword, and Date of Issue of Notification (From: 28-Jan-1922, To: 16-Sep-2026). Below the form, a table lists search results. The first result, 'The Companies Act, 2013', is highlighted with a red box. A red arrow points from the 'Subject' field in the search form to this result.

S. No.	Ministry / Organization	Department	Office	Subject	Category	Part & Section	Issue Date	Publish Date	Gazette ID	Download
1.	Ministry of Law and Justice	Legislative Department	NOT available	The Companies Act, 2013.	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 1	30-Aug-2013	02-Sep-2013	NOT available (155988)	2.04 MB
2.	Ministry of Law and Justice	Legislative Department	NOT available	An Act further to amend the Companies Act, 1956. BE it enacted by Parliament in the Fiftyeth Year of the Republic of India as follows	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 1	01-Apr-1999	01-Apr-1999	NOT available (41520)	0.63 MB
3.	Ministry of Law and Justice	Legislative Department	NOT available	An Act further to amend the Companies Act, 1956	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 1	01-Apr-1999	01-Apr-1999	NOT available (39171)	0.6 MB
4.	Ministry of Law, Justice and Company Affairs	Legislative Department	Not Applicable	An Ordinance further to amend the Companies Act 1956	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 1	25-Sep-1979	26-Mar-2013	NOT available (44909)	0.11 MB
5.	Ministry of Law, Justice and Company Affairs	Legislative Department	Not Applicable	An Act further to amend the Companies Act, 1956, the Securities	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 1	11-Sep-1974	26-Mar-2013	NOT available (94023)	1.87 MB
6.	Ministry of Law and Justice	Legislative Department	CSL	An Act further to amend the Companies Act, 1956. BE it enacted by Parliament in the Twenty-second Year of the Republic of India as follows	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 1	31-Dec-1971	26-Mar-2013	NOT available (99481)	0.06 MB

Figure 4. Screenshot embedded on supplied guide p. 6: the original Companies Act, 2013 appears with older Companies instruments. The oldest or bottom result is not automatically the baseline. Printed identity distinguishes the 1956 and 2013 legal families.

Maintain a typed relationship graph: **amends, commences, repeals, supersedes, corrects, made under, applies with modifications, exempts, and mentions**. One instrument may have several relationships and targets. A commencement notice **changes legal status without necessarily changing wording**; an S.O. schedule amendment changes wording as well. [S7-S9, S14]

For rules, link an amendment to the **principal rules notification**, not just to the Act. Companies (Incorporation) Rules and Companies (Accounts) Rules are **separate families** even though both sit under the Companies Act. A later instrument's history table can supply older G.S.R. numbers even when the portal title is unhelpful.

Candidate scoring can combine exact Act number/year, title aliases, enabling sections, quoted principal-notification identity, ministry and operative wording. These signals **propose links; they do not independently prove them**. Date and ministry are particularly weak as sole identifiers.

Store evidence at the relationship level: source document hash, page, quoted span or coordinates, target identity, reviewer and unresolved alternatives. When a source only mentions an Act, retain that observation **without turning it into an amendment event**.

Use **stable internal provision IDs**, with separate dated labels such as section 2(1)(a) or section 2(1)(aa). Renumbering can move the old provision to a new label while a different provision takes over the old label. **A section number alone cannot provide durable identity**.

15. Resolve Commencement Provision by Provision

Read the commencement clause first, then **identify exceptions** in individual amending provisions. The source may set a fixed date, provide immediate commencement, deem an earlier date, or delegate appointment of dates to a later notification. General Clauses Act section 5 supplies a default for Central Acts within its terms when no particular day is expressed; **do not mechanically transfer that default** to every subordinate notification. [S3]

1. Identify the source provision that creates the change.
2. Determine whether the instrument's general commencement rule governs that provision or an exception applies.
3. If commencement is delegated, **retrieve the actual appointing notification** and parse its included provisions, exclusions and territorial scope.
4. Record the legal date and its evidence. If the appointment cannot be found, **distinguish "not located" from a legally established "not yet commenced"**.
5. Revisit the chain when a corrigendum, retrospective amendment, replacement ordinance or later commencement notice appears.

The screenshot shows the 'Search Gazette by Category' interface on the egazette.gov.in website. The search criteria are as follows:

- Gazette Category: Extra Ordinary
- Ministry: Select Ministry
- Department: Select Department
- Office: Select Office
- Part & Section: Part II-Section 3-Sub-Section (ii)
- Issue No.: 2351
- Reference No. (GSR No. / S.O. No. / File No. / Notification No. / SRO No. / GI No.): 2351
- Subject: In exercise of the powers conferred by subsection 3 of section 1 of the Consumer Protection Act
- Keyword:
- Date of Issue of Notification: From: 14-Jul-2020 To: 18-Jul-2020

Buttons: Reset, Submit

Total No. of Gazettes : 1

S. No.	Ministry / Organization	Department	Office	Subject	Category	Part & Section	Issue Date	Publish Date	Gazette ID	Download
1.	Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution	Department of Consumer Affairs	Not Applicable	In exercise of the powers conferred by subsection 3 of section 1 of the Consumer Protection Act	Extra Ordinary	Part II-Section 3-Sub-Section (ii)	15-Jul-2020	16-Jul-2020	CG-DL-E-16072020-220546	1.01 MB

Figure 5. Supplied guide p. 11: Section 3(ii), reference 2351 and a narrow July 2020 date window locate the Consumer Protection commencement notification. Issue and Publish dates differ. Neither column replaces the operative commencement date.

S.O. 2351(E) is dated **15 July 2020** and appoints **20 July 2020** for the provisions it lists. The recorded portal row shows Issue Date 15 July and Publish Date 16 July. **Preserve all three values with their meanings.** [S9, E1]

For initial discovery, search a known date and widen the window if necessary. Category and text-search date fields have different observed meanings; **old instruments may be uploaded later**. A recently published portal record may therefore change an old historical interval.

Do not use a single Act-wide date when commencement is staggered. Store the provision set named in each notification. **Pending provisions remain separate from commenced ones**, even if the printed Act already contains both.

16. Keep Effective Time and Knowledge Time

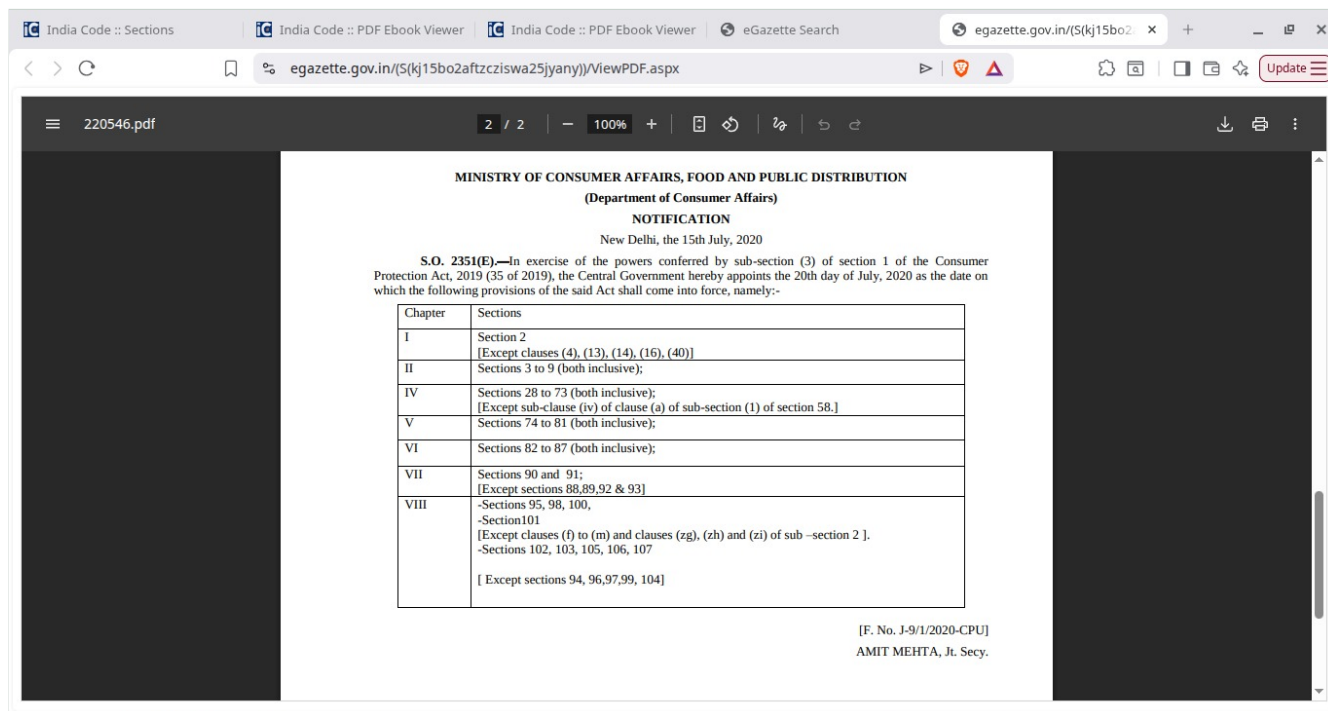


Figure 6. Supplied guide p. 12: the operative English paragraph of S.O. 2351(E). The listed chapters and exclusions determine scope. The source is the Gazette PDF, not the search result's date columns; this screenshot does not show the full masthead.

Effective time is when the law says a provision or change operates. **Knowledge time** is when a source or interpretation was available to the service. **Store both**. This is commonly called a bitemporal model.

Two legitimate questions then become distinguishable:

Query mode	Meaning
Historical date, using sources known now	Reconstruct the legal text for that date, including later legislation that expressly operates retrospectively.
Historical date, using a specified knowledge cutoff	Reconstruct only from sources available by that cutoff, with the resulting limitation made explicit.

Database ingestion time alone is not a complete measure of public availability. Store publication evidence separately so that "known to this database" is not confused with "knowable to the public".

For a retrospective change, append a new recorded interpretation with an earlier effective interval. Recompute affected historical snapshots while **retaining prior releases and their source cutoffs**. **Do not silently rewrite the audit history**.

Use effective intervals such as **[start, end)**: the start is included and the next version's start ends the previous version. If the source specifies a time or a conditional trigger, retain it instead of forcing every event into a date-only value. Conflicting or undetermined dates remain unresolved.

The same model explains partial collection: a 2014-source-cutoff reconstruction may be useful, but it cannot assert that no later retrospective enactment changes the legal account of 2014. This is a qualification of the evidence, **not a reason to discard the collected archive**.

17. Model Changes as Verifiable Events

The four editing ideas in the supplied notes are a useful start. They are **not an exhaustive classification of legal effects**. Insertion and addition can share one implementation with a position parameter; renumbering, repeal, commencement, supersession and conditional application need their own semantics.

Operation	Example, schematic	Required check
Insert	Insert section 5A after section 5.	Target neighbour exists; new label is valid for that date.
Add/append	Add a proviso at the end of subsection (2).	Correct unit and final position are identified.
Substitute	Replace specified words or an entire section.	Old span matches within the named scope; replacement is source-backed.
Omit	Omit clause (b) or specified words.	Exact target exists; retain its earlier versions.
Renumber/relocate	Renumber clause (a) as (aa).	Preserve identity; update dated address and dependent targets.
Repeal/supersede	Replace a principal instrument or end its operation.	Resolve scope, savings and continuation; do not just delete text.
Commence/apply/exempt	Appoint a date or qualify operation.	Update legal status/applicability separately from wording.

Each event needs: source instrument and amending provision; target instrument and unit; operation; **old-text precondition**; replacement text or inserted structure; **effective-date rule and source**; scope; dependencies; extraction/review status; and before/after hashes.

Replay procedure. Load the verified baseline. Select reviewed events relevant to the date and scope. Order by legal effect and explicit dependencies, resolving earlier retrospective changes and ordinance transitions. **Apply each operation only if its target and preconditions match.** Validate structure and save a new version with its provenance.

Where two events share a date, use textual dependencies and the legally established sequence, **not Gazette list order**. Independent edits can be applied together. An **unresolved conflict blocks only the affected reconstruction**; it must not be settled by arbitrary PDF order.

"Wherever they occur" needs an **explicit scope and expected match count**. An exact phrase can appear several times in different contexts. **Ambiguous targets and OCR mismatches go to review**; they are not permission to edit the closest-looking passage.

Storage choice: retain **full immutable provision versions** for reliable reads, plus structured events and periodic whole-Act snapshots for replay and comparison. Diffs are useful displays, but **should not be the only evidence of an old version**.

18. Worked Example: Commercial Courts

The 2018 amendment is **Act 28 of 2018**, assented to on **20 August 2018** and published in the Gazette dated **21 August 2018**. Section 1(2) deems commencement on **3 May 2018**, save as otherwise provided. The Gazette reproduction was retrieved through India Code's current amendment link for this report. [S17]

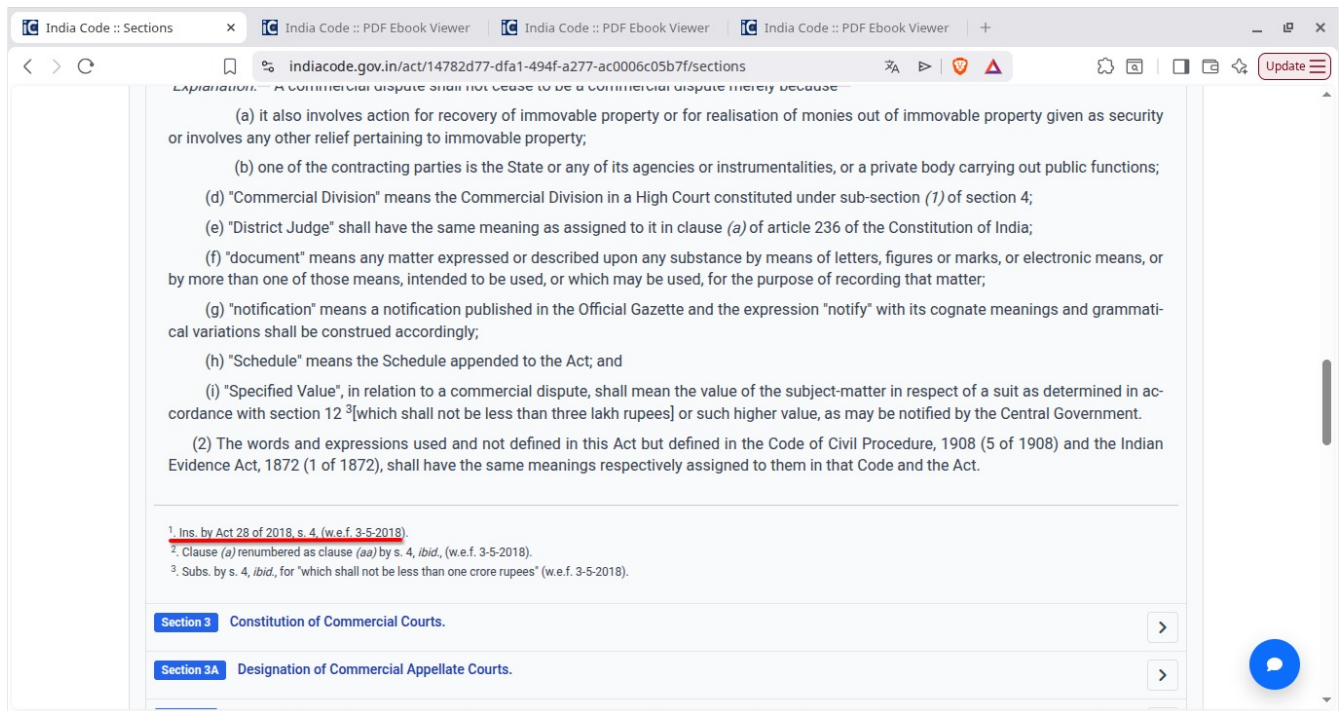


Figure 7. Supplied guide p. 8: section 2 and its three footnotes point to section 4 of Act 28 of 2018. The footnotes are a discovery and reconciliation aid. The amendment's operative wording establishes the actual operations and their relationship.

Section 4 of the amendment supplies **three linked operations**: preserve the former clause (a) by relabelling it **(aa)**; insert a new clause **(a)** defining Commercial Appellate Courts; and substitute the specified-value wording in clause **(i)** from a one-crore threshold to a three-lakh threshold. The **renumbering must occur before the old label is reused**. [S17, p. 2]

For the text lineage of clause (i), the event points to principal Act section 2(1)(i), amendment section 4(II), source p. 2, and effective date 2018-05-03 under amendment section 1(2). The prior version must contain the expected old wording; **otherwise the replay stops for investigation**.

Why one date per amendment PDF fails: section 18(iii) separately deems its schedule insertion effective from **23 October 2015**. Section 19 addresses application to cases by filing date. Section 20 repeals the preceding 2018 ordinance and saves actions taken under it. These are **distinct events, not incidental notes**. [S17, pp. 5-6]

This example verifies the source instructions; it is **not a completed reconstruction** of every Commercial Courts provision. A full history must also recover the preceding ordinance, baseline and other changes. Matching the current footnotes is **one cross-check, not the completeness test**.

19. Handle Difficult Legal Histories

Situation	Required treatment
Omnibus legislation	Read operative schedules and create one target relationship per affected Act. A title search cannot close this gap.
Amendment to a pending amendment	Model the target as the amending provision first; do not automatically patch the principal Act twice.
Retrospective insertion	Recompute earlier effective intervals while retaining when the later source was published and recorded.
Ordinance followed by an Act	Preserve both sources, differences, dates and savings; prevent duplicate application of carried-forward wording.
Ordinance cessation or withdrawal	Record the end of operation; obtain legal review of surviving effects. Do not automatically erase all consequences.
Repeal of an amending Act	Check General Clauses Act section 6A and the repealing text; completed amendments normally continue unless contrary intention appears.
Replacement principal Act	Keep predecessor and successor identities separate; resolve commencement, repeal and transitional overlap.
Corrigendum	Determine what source/language/span is corrected and its legal temporal effect; do not presume a fresh prospective amendment.
Territorial extension or adaptation	Model the affected territory and provisions; one national date may be insufficient.
Judicial ruling	Preserve enacted wording and add a sourced status/interpretation layer with operative order, date, scope and later treatment.
Form, schedule or table replacement	Version the structured unit and referenced annexures, not only running section text.

The constitutional and statutory foundations include Article 123 and General Clauses Act sections 6, 6A, 7 and 24. Their application can depend on the instrument and context. These rules **define review requirements**; they do not justify inferring a legal outcome from a filename or a generic event type. [S2, S3]

Same-day conflicts require review of legal dependencies. Preserve competing interpretations where necessary and **block publication of a single definitive version until resolved**.

A court ruling is more than a Boolean flag. If judicial effects are included, record the court, case, order, affected provision, territorial/precedential scope, stay or appeal status and any direction on temporal effect. A text-history release that **excludes judgment analysis should say so expressly**.

Backward reconstruction is sometimes possible where old wording and a complete amendment trail survive, but it is **not a general substitute for a verified baseline**. Current consolidations often omit text needed to reverse old deletions. **Forward reconstruction from a supported baseline** is the preferred default.

20. Extend to Rules and Regulations

The parent Act authorises rules or regulations **within defined limits**. General Clauses Act section 21 addresses amendment, variation and rescission of notifications, orders, rules and bye-laws under conferred powers, subject to the applicable manner, sanctions and conditions. Read it with the parent statute rather than treating it as an unlimited standalone power. [S3]

Create one timeline per **principal subordinate instrument**, linked to its parent Act and enabling provisions. For the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014, the principal notification is **G.S.R. 250(E), dated 31 March 2014**. Amendments to that family must **not be merged with Accounts, Nidhi or other Companies rule families** merely because of a shared Act or ministry. [S8]

Additional issue	Rule-family treatment
Draft publication	Mark proposed; do not apply as final rules. Track the later final instrument separately.
Different commencement wording	Read the rule's own clause and enabling law; do not presume assent or notification date controls.
Parliamentary laying	Check the exact parent provision and any modification/annulment. A laying requirement does not universally postpone commencement until the laying period expires.
Supersession	Start a successor instrument with its own baseline; preserve savings and earlier versions.
Parent repeal/re-enactment	Examine savings and General Clauses Act section 24; subordinate instruments do not automatically vanish in every case.
Different regulator or delegated authority	Record the authorising provision and authority history; search the appropriate Gazette and regulator archive.
Forms and annexures	Include replacement forms and tables in the versioned object when they form part of the rules.

Companies Act section 469 and the Commercial Courts rule-making provision illustrate parliamentary laying clauses. Their terms, including how later modification or annulment affects earlier action, need to be read precisely. [S5, S17]

LLM classification is helpful where the portal presents a flat list of principal rules and amendments. Require it to extract the claimed principal title/notification and the operative amendment language, then **verify those links against sources**. **Do not infer an amendment sequence solely** from "Second", "Third" or "Fourth" in titles.

Delivery boundary: full rule-family versioning is an extension. However, a notification altering an Act's own schedule is part of the initial Central-Act reconstruction scope. The distinction is **based on the legal target**, not on whether the source is labelled G.S.R., S.O., rule or order.

21. India Code Discovery Gaps: Evidence

The supplied **missing.md**, dated 23 September 2026, identifies Gazette instruments that **did not surface in recorded India Code searches**. The table below preserves that bounded claim. It is **not evidence that every India Code holding or consolidated text omits the same legal change**. [E2]

Principal family: Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014	Gazette evidence	India Code observation
Fourth Amendment Rules, 2019	G.S.R. 330(E) and 332(E) , both 25 April 2019; two separate PDFs. [S18, S19]	The logged sequence includes Third and Fifth, but the corresponding Fourth did not surface. Preserve both sources; their mutual legal relationship is unresolved.
Second Amendment Rules, 2023	G.S.R. 584(E) , 2 August 2023. [S20]	No corresponding August item surfaced in the recorded 2023 query traversal.
Third Amendment Rules, 2023	G.S.R. 790(E) , 20 October 2023. [S21]	No corresponding October item surfaced.
Amendment Rules, 2024	G.S.R. 411(E) , 16 July 2024. [S22]	No matching family item surfaced. Gazette subject itself misleadingly includes "NIDHI".
Amendment Rules, 2025	G.S.R. 426(E) , 27 June 2025. [S23]	No corresponding family item surfaced.
Second Amendment Rules, 2025	G.S.R. 579(E) , 26 August 2025. [S24]	No corresponding family item surfaced.

Additional check for this report. On 23 September 2026, all **1,183** API search records carrying the Companies Act's observed `act_id` were retrieved across **12 pages**, with stable counts and unique UUIDs. There were **36** title matches for "incorporation", including section and other records, **not 36 verified amendments**. The six groups above **did not appear under their expected family titles**. [E3]

Global queries were also fully traversed: "Companies Incorporation 2019" returned **1,334** records; 2023 returned **466**; 2024 and 2025 returned **567** each. Inspection of the family-title candidates supported the same discovery gaps. Those query results include unrelated material and are **not annual inventories**. [E3]

This fresh verification strengthens the claim of **non-discoverability through the checked routes**. It still cannot exclude a mislinked instrument, radically different title, scanned attachment inside another item or later reindexing. **Positive Gazette evidence and negative search evidence have different strengths**.

Do not count seven PDFs as seven legal amendments. The two April 2019 publications share the Fourth Amendment title and the reported operative date substitution. Their duplication, correction or replacement relationship **requires legal review before either is applied**.

22. Distinguish Real Gaps from Method Gaps

Several initially suspicious examples were cleared. Keeping them in the report makes the argument stronger: it shows that **omissions were tested rather than assumed**. [E2]

Example	Correct conclusion
S.O. 1256(E), Schedule V amendment	Gazette source exists and India Code item 508875 is reported present. It demonstrates an Acts-only method gap, not an India Code omission.
IBC section 255 and Eleventh Schedule	Amend the Companies Act and are reflected in consolidated-text footnotes. Missing from a Companies-title ladder is not missing from India Code.
G.S.R. 349(E)/2015 and 936(E)/2016	Recovered by Gazette reference chasing; corresponding India Code items were located. These demonstrate Gazette search/indexing misses.
Commercial Courts amendment, 2018	Present in India Code's amendment list; directly rechecked for this report.
IBC amendments in the supplied spot-check	Reported linked on India Code. No omission established by that check.
Consumer Protection commencement notices	Incomplete discovery checks; not established as missing textual amendments.
May 2026 Companies Schedule VII lead	Metadata lead in the supplied log; unresolved source and reconciliation work. Do not present as a proven omission.

Recommended evidence vocabulary: source verified; found in comparison source; not surfaced by specified searches; inaccessible; identity unresolved; relationship unresolved; untested lead. **Avoid a bare "missing" flag** without the checked scope and date.

A reproducible gap record should include the exact printed instrument citation, Gazette URL and hash, page-level identity evidence, India Code Act identifier, query strings, filters, pagination, raw responses, candidate records inspected and observation date. A sequence gap is a useful lead but **cannot establish absence by itself**.

The fresh India Code checks are preserved with the report's research sources. The earlier Gazette hashes and request provenance remain in the workspace corpus manifest. For external scrutiny, provide the source file and the **bounded search evidence** alongside the narrative claim.

What the evidence supports: India Code is a valuable official starting point, but a workflow confined to its readily discoverable linked records **can miss relevant instruments**. Independent Gazette acquisition and cross-source reconciliation are justified. The evidence **does not establish an archive-wide omission rate** or prove that all Central Acts have the same problem.

23. Verify History, Not Just the Latest Text

A current-text comparison is necessary but insufficient. An intermediate amendment may later have been reversed, leaving **today's text identical even when the earlier timeline is wrong**. Likewise, a late or missed commencement notification can shift an entire interval without changing the final wording.

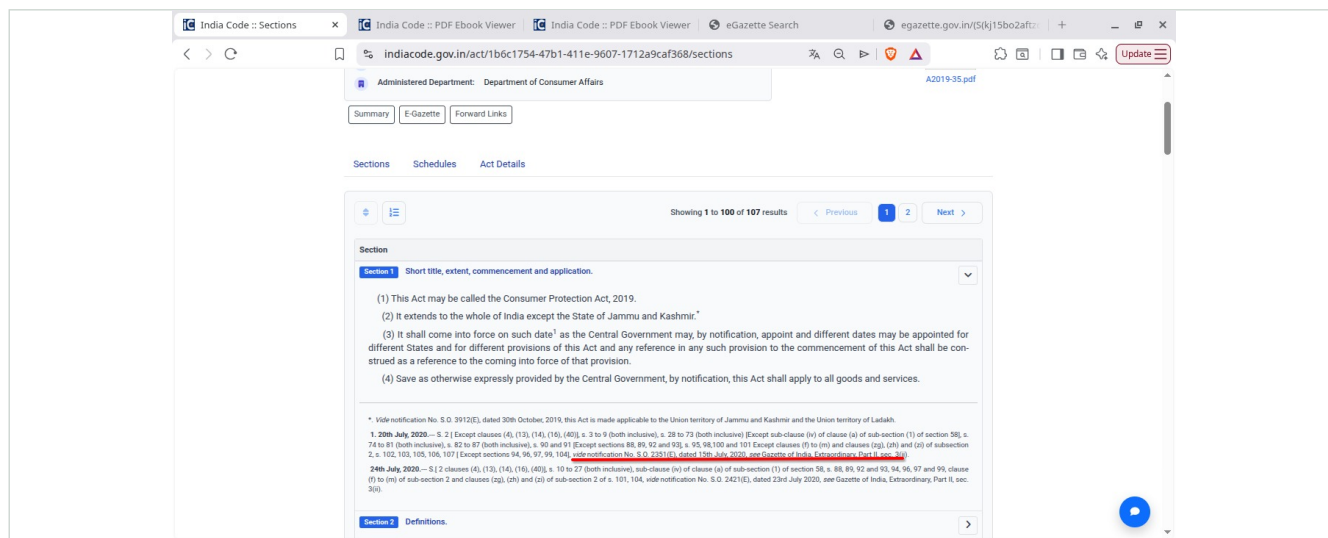


Figure 8. Supplied guide p. 10: Consumer Protection Act section 1 provides references to several commencement or territorial instruments. Follow each reference to its own scope. A section count and a readable latest text do not establish historical completeness.

Gate	Evidence needed to pass
Inventory	Exact principal identity, scope, baseline and predecessor/successor status resolved.
Collection	Planned publication partitions traversed; counts and required downloads reconciled; exceptions explicit.
Discovery	Official comparison indexes checked; known citations and relevant omnibus/delegated sources resolved.
Text quality	Operative spans and targets verified; scans/OCR and table issues closed for the release scope.
Legal events	Every applied edit and date has a source; ambiguous dependencies reviewed.
Replay	Preconditions pass; stable unit identities survive insertions, renumbering and omissions.
Historical validation	Reviewed examples before, on and after selected changes, including retrospective and staggered commencement cases.
Release	Reviewer sign-off, supported date/territory/language range, source cutoff and limitations recorded.

For the pilot, manually review **every extracted change event and commencement determination**. At scale, risk-based review can reduce effort for routine cases after measured validation; OCR uncertainties, retrospective effects, ordinance transitions and ambiguous targets should continue to require **explicit review**.

Compare the reconstructed latest text with India Code and another relevant official consolidation where available. **Investigate every difference**: extraction error, missed source, timing difference, editorial formatting or source lag. Agreement is evidence of one endpoint, **not proof of the full timeline**.

24. Data Contract and Audit Trail

The following model supports the first Central-Act release while accommodating subordinate instruments later. It **avoids encoding a portal's current layout as the legal model**.

Entity	Essential fields
Instrument	Internal ID; kind; jurisdiction; number/year or notification identity; exact/alias titles; authority; parent links.
Gazette record	Portal IDs; category; Part/Section; original subject; ministry; Issue/Publish dates; query provenance.
Source file	URL; retrieval timestamp; hash; bytes; pages; immutable file; language and extraction records.
Instrument occurrence	Instrument ID; source file; page span; printed citation; language/version relationship.
Provision	Stable ID; parent ID; unit type; dated labels; source spans.
Change event	Source provision; target; operation; precondition; new content; dependencies; review state.
Commencement/effect	Target provision set; effective date or condition; scope; authority; status; evidence.
Provision version	Stable ID; text/structure; effective interval; recorded interval; source-event chain; hashes.
Coverage record	Act/track/date partition; planned scope; observed counts; completed checks; unresolved gaps.
Release	Versioned dataset ID; cutoff; supported scope; review decisions; build/tool versions.

Illustrative event, grounded in the worked example:

```
{
  "target": "central-act:2016:4/section-2/subsection-1/clause-i",
  "source": "central-act:2018:28/section-4/II",
  "operation": "substitute",
  "effective_from": "2018-05-03",
  "effective_date_authority": "central-act:2018:28/section-1/2",
  "source_page": 2,
  "review_status": "required_before_release"
}
```

The example omits payload and hash fields for readability; production events must include them. These identifiers are **proposed internal conventions, not official government IDs**.

At query time, return the requested text together with its effective interval, source links, provenance chain, scope and completeness status. If no reviewed version covers the request, **return an explicit unresolved interval** and the best available evidence; **do not fabricate continuity between known snapshots**.

Reproducibility: a release should be **rebuildable from immutable sources**, reviewed event records and pinned transformation versions. Model-assisted outputs need **prompt/model provenance and reviewer corrections**, so rerunning an LLM does not silently redefine a published legal history.

25. Pilot and Delivery Gates

Use five Acts with deliberately different reconstruction difficulties. These are proposed pilot choices, **not a claim that their histories have already been completed**.

Candidate	Reason for inclusion	Required demonstration
Companies Act, 2013	Rich existing corpus; ordinances; omnibus and delegated schedule changes.	Resolve beyond the named-amendment ladder.
Commercial Courts Act, 2015	Clear insertion, renumbering, substitution and retrospective exceptions.	Replay the sourced 2018 example and preceding ordinance transition.
Consumer Protection Act, 2019	Useful staged-commencement evidence.	Build provision-specific commencement sets.
Indian Contract Act, 1872	Directly matches the motivating 1976 question.	Demonstrate pre-1950 baseline acquisition and a defensible 1976 interval, or identify the exact blocking sources.
Post Office Act, 2023	More recent, smaller baseline and predecessor relationship.	Demonstrate original-to-commencement-to-replacement links.

Run Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014 as a **separate extension pilot**. It tests family grouping, rule amendments, forms, poor search labels and the India Code discovery-gap examples.

Stage	Deliverable	Completion gate
A. Inventory and source design	Reconciled pilot register and acquisition plan.	Exact identities and scope approved internally by legal/data leads.
B. Collection	Source archive, partition ledger and unresolved-reference queue.	Required sources acquired or explicit interval blockers recorded.
C. Interpretation	Reviewed relationships, operations and commencement records.	Source-backed events; unresolved legal ambiguities isolated.
D. Reconstruction	Date-query output, diffs and reproducible snapshots.	Replay checks and historical review passed for declared intervals.
E. Release and surveillance	Bounded pilot release and update process.	Cutoff, limitations, ownership and recheck schedule published.

Measure time spent on collection, OCR, relationship classification, legal review and replay failures separately. **Report unresolved sources and provision/date coverage**, not just PDFs downloaded or Acts touched. Use known-source recovery tests to measure discovery performance; **do not infer true recall over an unknown archive**.

Do not promise a fixed national completion schedule from the present pilot. **Estimate throughput after measuring the five dossiers**, with separate strata for modern text PDFs and older scans. Storage, processing and expert review have different cost drivers.

26. Maintain the Corpus and State Its Limits

Monitor new portal publications in overlapping windows, preserve a watermark only after successful traversal, and **periodically rescan historical issue-date partitions** for backfills or corrected metadata. Re-fetch changed sources into new immutable versions; **retain the earlier bytes** and explain the discrepancy. [E1]

Route each new instrument to candidate Act or rule families, resolve its relationships and dates, then **rebuild only affected provision histories**. **A new publication can affect an old interval**, so updates must invalidate historical snapshots where appropriate, not just append a latest version.

Risk	Control	What remains uncertain
Incomplete official archive	Multiple official indexes, reference chasing and archival acquisition.	Unknown or inaccessible publications can remain.
Incorrect portal metadata	Preserve metadata and verify printed sources.	Discovery can still miss misclassified items.
OCR or parsing error	Page-linked extraction and critical-span review.	Unresolved scans block affected versions.
Wrong effective date	Provision-level commencement evidence.	Conditional or contested effects need legal review.
Incorrect parent link	Exact identities and operative references.	Similar titles and duplicate notifications can remain ambiguous.
LLM overconfidence	Schema validation, source spans, preconditions and review.	Model scores are not proof of legal correctness.
Current text mistaken for full history	Historical boundary tests and coverage ledger.	Complete historical recall cannot be inferred from one endpoint.

Assign clear ownership: data engineering owns retrieval and integrity; legal editors own event interpretation and disputed relationships; a reviewer checks release samples and high-risk cases; the product owner defines supported scope and claims. These are roles, not an assumed staffing commitment.

Before national scaling, settle the **earliest supported date**, treatment of pre-independence enactments, inclusion of State variations, authoritative-language policy, judicial-effect scope, and the **threshold for releasing a partially resolved Act**. These decisions need not prevent the proposed pilot from starting under explicitly stated defaults.

Recommended public claim: "Source-backed reconstructions of Central legislative text for the stated Acts, dates and scope, with linked change evidence and disclosed coverage limitations." Reserve stronger claims for ranges that have passed the documented gates. This report is a methodology and evidence assessment; it **does not certify that the present pilot corpus already satisfies them**.

Appendix A. Corrections to the Supplied Guide

The supplied notes and illustrated guide establish the intended workflow. Several simplifications need correction before that workflow is used for historical legal claims.

Starting assumption	Corrected position
Part II Section 1A contains Bills.	It contains authoritative Hindi texts of Acts, Ordinances and Regulations. Bills/ select committee reports belong in Section 2.
All wording changes require a named Amendment Act.	Omnibus legislation, ordinances and express delegated powers can also matter; schedules can be amended by notification.
S.O.s supply dates only; G.S.R.s can always be skipped.	Classify operative effects. The source series alone cannot determine relevance to Act text.
India Code's full-Act PDF is the original.	It may be consolidated and amended. Verify the original Gazette or a declared historical baseline separately.
Portal Issue/Publish years are always re-upload dates.	They have differing observed meanings. Preserve both and compare to printed dates.
Removing punctuation improves Subject search.	Tested punctuation removal caused a known match to disappear.
The bottom search result is the original Act.	Ordering and title overlap are unreliable; identify the printed principal instrument.
Four text-edit types cover every change.	They are common operations, not all legal effects. Add identity, status, date and scope events.
Renumbering is only bookkeeping.	It changes addresses and can reuse labels for different provisions. Preserve stable identity.
Gazette order resolves same-day amendments.	Legal dependencies and operative text control; conflicts require review.
Current-text equality proves the history.	Intermediate changes may cancel out. Historical intervals require independent validation.
Partial broad collection is unusable.	It supports bounded research and reviewed intervals, subject to cutoff and retrospective-change limits.
Repeal of the parent always ends its rules.	Examine specific savings and General Clauses Act section 24.

Appendix B. Source Register: Foundations

Source labels in the report identify the exact documents below. Links are clickable in the PDF. **Official legislative texts establish legal propositions; project evidence establishes the bounded retrieval observations.** Sources accessed or locally inspected for this report on **23 September 2026**, unless an earlier investigation date is stated.

S1. Gazette classification. Department of Publication, Contents of Gazette of India Notifications, pp. 1-2. Official legacy classification guide; local verified research copy: [evidence/gazette-parts-official.pdf](#). [Official PDF](#).

S2. Constitution of India. Legislative Department edition as on 1 May 2024. Articles 107-111, 123, 240 and 372 are the provisions used here. [Official PDF](#). This is a dated official edition, not a claim about every subsequent constitutional development.

S3. General Clauses Act, 1897 (10 of 1897). Sections 5, 6, 6A, 7, 21-24 and 30; official India Code consolidation retrieved via the current public API. [Retrieved PDF](#). Source metadata retained with the report.

S4. Ministry roles. Ministry of Law and Justice, official MyGov institutional description: Legislative Department, Department of Legal Affairs and Department of Justice. [Official description](#).

S5. Companies Act, 2013 (18 of 2013). Enabling-power examples: sections 467 and 469. [Original Gazette PDF](#). Read the relevant provision version when evaluating a later exercise of power.

S6. Indian Contract Act, 1872 (9 of 1872). India Code consolidation, opening provisions and commencement; current-source check only, **not the reconstructed 1976 version**. [India Code record](#).

S7. S.O. 1256(E), 18 March 2021. Companies Act Schedule V changes under section 467; operative English text pp. 2-3. [Gazette PDF](#).

S8. G.S.R. 250(E), 31 March 2014. Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014, principal publication. [Gazette PDF](#).

S9. S.O. 2351(E), 15 July 2020. Consumer Protection Act commencement; operative English text p. 2 appoints 20 July 2020 for the listed provisions. [Gazette PDF](#).

S10. Alphabetical list of Central Acts. Legislative Department PDF downloaded for this report; last serial number 891. [Official PDF](#).

S11. Chronological list of Central Acts. Legislative Department PDF downloaded for this report; last serial number 859. [Official PDF](#). Use the actual table headers; the number column is Act No., not a page number.

S12. Repeal inventory. Legislative Department, List of Repealed Acts from 1950 to May 2014 through various Repealing and Amending Acts and other Acts. [Official PDF](#). This is a **period-specific supplement, not the complete historical inventory**.

Appendix C. Source Register: Instruments

S13. Commercial Courts Act, 2015 (4 of 2016). India Code Act page and consolidated PDF; current sections and amendment controls checked. [Act page](#).

S14. Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016 (31 of 2016). Section 255 and Eleventh Schedule amend the Companies Act. [Gazette PDF](#), including the Eleventh Schedule beginning at PDF p. 102.

S15. Original Companies Act, 2013. Printed Act 18 of 2013; retained separately from later consolidated text. [Gazette PDF](#).

S16. Central Secretariat Library. Gazette of India digitisation description, covering the reported 1950-2002 digitisation programme. [Official page](#).

S17. Commercial Courts amendment, Act 28 of 2018. Full title: The Commercial Courts, Commercial Division and Commercial Appellate Division of High Courts (Amendment) Act, 2018. Gazette dated 21 August 2018, reproduced on India Code. Source pp. 1-2 and 5-6 support the worked example. [Retrieved official PDF](#). This copy carries an India Code watermark; a direct eGazette copy should also be preserved for the production dossier.

S18. G.S.R. 330(E), 25 April 2019. Companies (Incorporation) Fourth Amendment Rules, 2019. [Gazette PDF](#). SHA-256: 7be9911d9885e90814a74fdce943486d483fdd43c4ff2fcd0f79fc352f0357e7.

S19. G.S.R. 332(E), 25 April 2019. Same printed rule short title as S18; **separate source, not silently deduplicated**. [Gazette PDF](#). SHA-256: 01594a9df381a136c65b53372f02c1dc24a55fa7ead2489b35bad6fa21604d87.

S20. G.S.R. 584(E), 2 August 2023. Companies (Incorporation) Second Amendment Rules, 2023. [Gazette PDF](#).

S21. G.S.R. 790(E), 20 October 2023. Companies (Incorporation) Third Amendment Rules, 2023. [Gazette PDF](#).

S22. G.S.R. 411(E), 16 July 2024. Companies (Incorporation) Amendment Rules, 2024; distinguish printed short title from misleading portal subject. [Gazette PDF](#).

S23. G.S.R. 426(E), 27 June 2025. Companies (Incorporation) Amendment Rules, 2025. [Gazette PDF](#).

S24. G.S.R. 579(E), 26 August 2025. Companies (Incorporation) Second Amendment Rules, 2025. [Gazette PDF](#).

Appendix D. Evidence and Verification Record

E0. Supplied material. Time-Versioned-Central-Acts-Amendment-Path.pdf, 13 pages, and Time-Versioned Central Acts of India - Approach Notes, dated 21 September 2026. Figures 1-8, including the detail accompanying Figure 2, reproduce all nine embedded source screenshots at their original resolution, scaled to fit the new report. Original red annotations are retained. Captions in this report supersede the original guide's interpretations where they conflict with verified sources. These screenshots are dated source material, not new live captures.

E1. Existing retrieval investigation. Workspace FINDINGS.md, README.md, evidence/search-experiments.csv, evidence/summary.json, evidence/partition-comparison.json, raw request directories and corpus/manifest.json; investigation 21 September 2026. Counts: 57 experiments, 1,673 metadata records, 112 PDFs, 3,112 pages, 261 low-text flags. The stored summary explicitly sets legal_family_complete and amendment_operations_parsed to false. Report claims preserve these limits.

E2. Supplied gap log. Workspace missing.md, updated 23 September 2026. It distinguishes reported discovery gaps, cleared examples and unverified leads. The Gazette side is supported by local PDFs and the corpus manifest; a **negative search result is not treated as proof of absolute absence**.

E3. Checks performed for this report, 23 September 2026. Current India Code UI inspected using agent-browser. Commercial Courts sections and Show Amendment modal verified; amendment PDF downloaded through the current public API. Complete traversal of the 1,183 Companies Act-linked search records and four global year queries saved under report/sources/. Queries, raw responses, response hashes and timestamps are in indiacode-requests.json; extracted candidate lists are adjacent.

The principal bounded query was dc.identifier.act_id:AC_CEN_22_29_00008_201318_1517807327856. It used the publicly observed /server/api/discover/search/objects route with 100 results per page. Count stability and UUID uniqueness were checked. The four additional queries were the literal strings "Companies Incorporation 2019", "Companies Incorporation 2023", "Companies Incorporation 2024" and "Companies Incorporation 2025". Titles, dates and returned metadata were assessed; this was **not a full-text audit of every attachment** on India Code.

Source-access qualification. Some legacy India Code PDF URLs failed during this report's collection. The relevant General Clauses, Contract and Commercial Courts texts were recovered through current official item/bitstream links. The Gazette examples use the earlier TLS-verified local corpus; this report **does not claim to have re-run the entire 57-experiment Gazette suite**.

What this deliverable adds. A corrected and integrated methodology, source-linked legal foundations, a comparison of the three strategies, explicit reconstruction and acceptance rules, fresh bounded India Code verification, and the supplied screenshots with corrected explanations. It **does not implement or certify a national time-versioned corpus**.